
Introduction

An important consideration when developing transdisciplinary education is the question of **where in the curriculum** the education is embedded (Horn et al., 2021). You can choose between **intra- or extracurricular, mandatory or elective**, and **bachelor or master** level. It's important to take into account various factors such as educational needs, organizational possibilities, and the interests of partners. Ideally, the decision-making process is driven by the **desired outcomes for all partners**.

The **Practice** page provides a more detailed description of these options, including the pros and cons of each.

Under the **Theory** tab, you'll find an overview of the choices involved in implementing a transdisciplinary education project.

Theory

Here are **three key decisions** to make when developing transdisciplinary education in higher education:

Intra- or Extracurricular

A major decision is whether the educational program is **extracurricular** or **intracurricular**.

- **Equitable development** is a key concept in the transdisciplinary sideh

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- **Interdisciplinary options** These are separate classes, minors, majors, or certificates

Mandatory or Elective

Another choice is whether the program is **mandatory** or offered as an **elective**.

- **Designing an interdisciplinary program** is a choice that is offered in the context of a program that is already in place
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Bachelor or Master

It's also important to determine whether transdisciplinary education takes place at the **bachelor** or **master** level.

Different motivations apply here:

- **for a bachelor program**, interdisciplinary education offers a broad-based education that provides students with a wide range of knowledge and skills
- **for a master program**, students can expand their expertise and develop specialized skills

Bachelor-level education will be more introductory and exploratory, while master-level content will be more complex and in-depth. The choice to include transdisciplinary education in a bachelor or master program depends on the **goals of the program**, the **expected learning outcomes**, and the **academic and professional readiness** of the students.

Scheduling

Finally, it's essential that the chosen format aligns with the preferences of participants — including students, researchers, teachers, and societal partners. It's also important to consider whether all participants are present at the same time.

- **Good equitable learning community** present promote a
- **competencies** allow for a **deeper exploration** of multiple

References:

[Our study of the Research Group on Transdisciplinary Collaboration in Education, currently under review in the Transdisciplinary Journal of Education](#)
[Transdisciplinary Journal of Education](#) (2023) Affinity studies for

Practice

An interesting example from practice:

An **extracurricular transdisciplinary module** at **Utrecht University** — featuring an interview with co-initiator **Brianne McGonigle**.



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This module is part of Utrecht University's broader efforts in **transdisciplinary education**, which brings together students, academic actors (researchers and teachers), and extra-academic actors (from public and private sectors) to collaboratively address societal challenges.